

Games & Fun Pack • Spot the Fishy

Games and Fun

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

FIELD COPY

1

hackles up!



Hackle

whose quills stand up when something feels off

2



Latch

LOCK IT

3



Peeper

SPOT IT

4



Pip

SHARE SMART

5



Buddy

SAFE PEOPLE

6



Ember

KIND AND WELL

7



Fixit

FIX IT

PLATE I. The Hackles crew, drawn from life: Hackle (1) and the six friends who look after each strand.

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[Logo: Hackles]

SPOT THE FISHY

A sorting-and-noticing card game for grades K-12, 2 to 30 players

Trust your hackles. *Pause · Check · Tell*

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No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.

Teacher Quick Start (one page, print and keep)

What it is: you read a short message or situation. Teams whisper, then all hold up FISHY, REAL or PAUSE AND ASK at the same time. You read the back. The class fills a Pond together. Nobody is out.

You need (5 minutes to prepare): the deck (K-5 or 6-12, see the Printables checklist), 3 answer cards per team, a Pond Mat drawn on the board, 12 or 30 circles to color in, green Pass cards, a timer (optional).

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	TIME
1	Make 4 to 6 mixed teams of 3 to 5. Say the two promises: "A false alarm is fine. It is never your fault."	1 min
2	Practice the three answers once: "Show me FISHY! REAL! PAUSE AND ASK!"	1 min
3	Read the front of the top card in a fun voice. Read it twice, slowly.	20 sec
4	Whisper-think (10 seconds). Teams huddle. No calling out.	10 sec
5	Say "Peek!" All teams hold up an answer at the same moment.	5 sec
6	Reveal: read the back (the sort, the clue, what to do). Say "Nice noticing!" to every team.	20 sec
7	Fill the Pond: +1 circle always; +1 more if at least half the teams showed the best answer; +1 for each new clue a team names (max 2).	10 sec
8	Hackles move: the whole class does Hackles Up, Pause Palm, Check Eyes, Tell Wave.	5 sec

Time: Quick Catch = 8 cards, about 10 minutes (Mini Pond of 12 circles).
Full Pond = 24 cards in 3 rounds, about 30 minutes (Pond of 30 plus Lagoon of 24).

Pearl Table (only if you want team tallies; skip for K-2): showed the best answer = 3 pearls. Showed PAUSE AND ASK and named one way to check = 2. Anything else = 1. Everyone earns at least 1 on every card.

If...

- **Teams all choose PAUSE AND ASK for everything:** ask "What would you check?" before scoring. On FISHY and REAL cards, PAUSE AND ASK only earns 2 if the team names a check (call the number I have, open the app myself, ask in person, ask a trusted adult).
- **A child freezes or looks upset:** "Pass, please" is always fine. Offer a Pass card, move on warmly, check in later.
- **A child says "this happened to me" or "my uncle fell for that":** thank them, say it is never anyone's fault, and follow the disclosure box in your Teacher Guide. Do not promise secrecy.

- **The Pond fills early:** keep going; start the Lagoon.
- **The Pond is not full at the end:** the Reader adds "Peeper's Boost" circles so the class finishes together. The class cannot lose.

Never: make a child read aloud, ask anyone to play the trickster, use a real message from your school, or end with "you lost".

1 At a glance

SPECIMEN LABEL	
PLAYERS	2 to 30. Best as 4 to 6 teams of 3 to 5 children. Also works as a 2 to 4 player table game.
TIME	10-minute "Quick Catch" (8 cards) or 30-minute "Full Pond" (24 cards in three rounds)
AGES	K-5 deck: 66 cards, K-2 can play the star subset. 6-12 deck: 66 cards, with 11 twin pairs.
STYLE	Cooperative class game. Teams earn "Pearls" that fill one shared Pond. Nobody is out. Nobody loses.
NEEDS	Printed deck, 3 answer cards per team (shape-coded, see Components), a Pond Mat (plus a 24-circle Lagoon strip for Full Pond), pearl tokens or crayons for circles, a timer, green Pass cards
STRANDS	B Spot It (main), F Fix It, C Share Smart, A Lock It

THE LEARNING GOAL

Players will be able to **notice** the clues that make a message, offer, or picture feel fishy (secrets, pressure, offers too good to be true, tricks to make you act, strange senders and links), **sort** real from fishy, and know that **"Pause and ask" is always a safe move**, especially when you cannot tell. They practice the Hackles routine out loud on every card: **Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell.**

LESSONS THIS GAME REINFORCES

BAND	LESSONS
K-2	L3 Pause and Ask; L8 Real or Pretend?; L4 The Oops Button
3-5	L3 Scam Spotters (the SPOT checklist); L8 Real or Fake?; L10 Oops Recovery
6-8	L3 Phish Lab (the FLAGS checklist); L7 Response Drill (optional (H) cards); L8 Fakes That Hurt (optional)
9-12	L3 Social Engineering Case Lab; L6 Synthetic Media and Truth; L2 Credentials and Passkeys

THE BIG IDEA BEHIND THE GAME

Most scam-spotting games have two piles: **scam** and **not scam**. That teaches kids to feel brave about guessing, but it hides the truth: very often you **cannot tell** from the message alone. The best move then is neither "click" nor "ignore forever". It is **pause and ask**. So Spot the Fishy has **three** answer cards, and the third is the hero.

ANSWER CARD	PICTURE	MEANING
FISHY	A silly fish with a hook in its mouth	"My hackles are up. I think this is a trick."
REAL	A gold star	"This looks safe: I know who it is from, and I expected it or a trusted adult set it up."
PAUSE AND ASK	A flat palm like a stop sign	"I can't tell. I will pause and check a different way, or ask a trusted adult."

Field note

No. 1

Peeper says: "A false alarm is fine! If you say FISHY and it was real, you just did a great Check. If you say PAUSE AND ASK, you can never be wrong."

2 Components

- 1. The deck.** Print the K-5 deck (Section 7) or the 6-12 deck (Section 8) on card stock. Each card has a **front** (what is read aloud) and a **back** (the answer and the lesson). In the lists below, the front is the "Card" column and the back is "Sort" and "Why and what to do". When you print, put the front and the back on separate sides, or fold index cards.
- 2. Answer cards (3 per team).** Fish, Star, Palm. Make them from colored paper: Fish is coral, Star is sunshine yellow, Palm is sky. **Never rely on color alone** (roughly 1 child in 12 boys and 1 in 200 girls has a color-vision difference [VERIFY]): each card also has a different **shape and a big word** (FISHY on a fish-shaped card, REAL on a star-shaped card, PAUSE AND ASK on a hand-shaped card) and a different **notched corner** so fingers can tell them apart. Or use hands: hand brushed up the neck for FISHY, star hands for REAL, Pause Palm for PAUSE AND ASK. Children who cannot use those hands may point to a poster, say the word, or tap a picture on a tray.
- 3. The Pond Mat.** A strip of 30 circles (described below). When the class earns a pearl, color in or cover one circle.
- 4. Pearls (optional).** Pom-poms, beans or paper circles for the Pearl Table team tally (K-2 uses one "Pearl Jar" for the whole class). The Pond circles themselves are colored in, not counted out.
- 5. Reader's Card (for the teacher):** the Reader reads the front, waits for the whisper-think, calls "Peek!", then reads the back.
- 6. Pass cards.** Green, with the word PASS and a big check-mark symbol (so color is not the only clue). Any player may use one on any card, no questions asked.
- 7. Timer.** Optional. A 10-second quiet think.

THE POND MAT (PRINT OR DRAW)

Draw a curvy "pond" with 30 circles in 3 rows of 10. Label the rows with the Crew.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Row 1: Shore (Peeper)	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Row 2: Shallows (Hackle)	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Row 3: Deep (Fixit)	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○

- Circle 10 has a gold star (**Peeper's Cheer**: everybody does the Hackles Up hand signal and shouts "Spot it!").
- Circle 20 has a gold star (**Hackle's Wave**: everybody does the Tell Wave).
- Circle 30 has a big gold star and a drawing of the **Too-Good Box** with a party hat that says "You Spotted Me!" (see 02 The Hackles Trail).
- **Lagoon strip (Full Pond only)**: 24 more circles in 2 rows of 12, labeled "Fixit's Lagoon". **Mini Pond (Quick Catch)**: just 12 circles drawn on the board.

3 Rules: the Full Game

SETUP (2 MINUTES)

1. Divide the class into **teams of 3 to 5** (4 to 6 teams). Mix on purpose: do not let friends always pair up.
2. Give each team their 3 answer cards and a Pass card for each member.
3. Put the Pond Mat where everyone can see it. Shuffle the deck. Choose a **Reader** (the teacher at first; later a child who wants to read; never forced).
4. Read the two promises: "**A false alarm is fine. It is never your fault.**"
5. Teach the three answer cards and practice once: "Show me FISHY!" "Show me REAL!" "Show me PAUSE AND ASK!"

A TURN (ONE CARD, ABOUT 1 MINUTE)

1. **Read.** The Reader reads the front of the top card. Read it in a fun voice. If it is a scammy pop-up, give it a big silly announcer voice.
2. **Whisper-think (10 seconds).** Teams huddle and whisper. No yelling out. (This is the Pause step practiced for real.)
3. **Peek!** On "Peek!", all teams hold up an answer card at the same time. Hold it up high so everyone can see.
4. **Reveal.** The Reader reads the **back**: the correct sort, the clues, and what to do.
5. **Score the sort.** See Scoring below. Say "Nice noticing!" to every team, whatever they showed.
6. **Name the Flag (bonus).** Any team may say one clue they noticed (K-5: use SPOT; 6-12: use FLAGS). Each new, correct clue named earns **1 extra Pond circle** for the class (max 2 per card).
7. **Do the Hackles move.** The whole class does the signals together for the right action: Hackles Up, Pause Palm, Check Eyes (or magnifier), Tell Wave. Takes 5 seconds. It is the whole point.
8. **Fill the Pond.** Color in the circles the class earned (see Scoring) and read the circle's cheer if it has one.

SCORING: THE CLASS POND (WHAT MATTERS) AND THE PEARL TABLE (OPTIONAL)

1. The Pond is a class tally. After every card the class colors in circles:

WHY	CIRCLES
Every card (always)	+1
At least half of the teams showed the best answer for that card	+1
Each new, correct clue a team names (Name the Flag), maximum 2 per card	+1 each

Playtest note: we ran tens of thousands of simulated games (4, 5 and 6 teams, from "mostly guessing" to "expert" teams). The class earns about 2 circles per card, so 30 circles fill in about 13 to 15 cards (never fewer than 8). The earlier "add up every team's pearls" rule filled a 30-pearl pond in only 2 or 3 cards, which is why it was replaced.

Goals: Quick Catch (8 cards): a **Mini Pond of 12 circles**. Full Pond (24 cards): the **Pond (30) plus Fixit's Lagoon (24)**, 54 circles. **Peeper's Boost:** if the class is a few circles short on the last card, the Reader adds the missing circles with a flourish. The class cannot lose.

2. The Pearl Table (optional team tally; skip it with K-2 and with groups where competition stings). Teams may keep their own pearls for fun. The prize is still the class Pond.

THE CARD IS...	YOU SHOWED FISHY	YOU SHOWED REAL	YOU SHOWED PAUSE AND ASK
FISHY	3 pearls (great spotting)	1 pearl (Learning Pearl: now you know the clue)	2 pearls if you name one way to check (otherwise 1)
REAL	1 pearl (good gut check: false alarm is fine)	3 pearls (nice noticing)	2 pearls if you name one way to check (otherwise 1)
PAUSE AND ASK	1 pearl	1 pearl	3 pearls (you spotted the "can't tell")

Pause needs a Check. Pausing is always a safe move, so it always scores. But a team that shows PAUSE AND ASK on a card that is clearly FISHY or REAL earns the full 2 pearls only if it says *how it would check* ("I'd open the app myself," "I'd call the number I already have," "I'd ask a trusted adult"). Without this rule, showing PAUSE AND ASK on every card is the best pearl strategy for any team that is right less than 6 times in 10 (we measured it), and the game would teach "never decide" instead of "pause and check".

Why nobody gets zero: every team earns at least 1 pearl on every card. A mistake is a Learning Pearl, never a loss. This is on purpose: we want kids to feel safe saying "I'm not sure."

Winning: the class wins together by filling the Pond. If the Pond fills early, keep going and start the Lagoon ("Pond 2: Fixit's Lagoon").

SPECIAL CARD ACTIONS

- **Twin Flip (6-12 deck):** Some cards are twins: one fishy, one real, with a nearly identical look. When you draw one, the Reader also reads its twin (pair table in Section 8). Teams explain what is *different*. Great for learning that fishy things copy real things.
- **(H) cards (6-12 deck):** Heavy cards. When one comes up, the class does the **Response Drill** together: STOP (do not reply, do not pay), SAVE (screenshots of words and links, not of private images), TELL, REPORT. Remove (H) cards for any opted-out class.
- **Wild "Ask Buddy":** Once per game, a team that is truly stuck may "Ask Buddy" (the Reader reads the first clue on the back). The team then answers normally and **scores normally**: asking for help is a strength, so it is never taxed. Cheer for it.

ENDING THE GAME

End with a **Peeper's Pause**: each team shares one thing they will remember. Hackles Up, Pause, Check, Tell chant. Hand out "Spotter Stickers" or Passport stamps (see 07).

4 10-minute "Quick Catch"

Use as: warm-up, recess game, station, last 10 minutes.

1. Pre-select **8 cards**: 3 FISHY, 3 REAL, 2 PAUSE AND ASK. (Suggested: K-5 deck K1, K6, K19, K23, K27, K31, K45, K49. 6-12 deck T2, T9, T13, T26, T36, T42, T46, T48.)
2. Draw a **Mini Pond of 12 circles** on the board. Goal: fill it (Peeper's Boost tops it up if needed).
3. 6 seconds whisper-think. Skip the Name the Flag bonus except on the last card.
4. Close with the chant.

5 30-minute "Full Pond" (three rounds)

ROUND	MINUTE S	FOCUS	HOW IT DIFFERS
1: Notice	10	Sort 8 cards	Standard rules. Teams only show a card.
2: Name	10	Name the flags on 8 new cards	Before scoring, one team member names one clue out loud . Each correct, new clue earns +1 Pond circle.
3: Move	10	Do the move on 8 cards	After scoring, one team must act out the right next step (K-5: a 5-second mime of Pause and Tell Wave; 6-12: say the one-sentence Tell script from the Ladder). Teams never act out the sneaky part.

Total 24 cards. Pond (30) plus Lagoon (24) = 54 circles; finish with the **Pearl Cheer**. Real timing: 24 cards at about 75 seconds each is 30 minutes, so cut Round 1 to 6 cards if your class is chatty.

6 Variants for each grade band

K-2 "FISHY FISH HUNT" (AGES 5-7)

- **Cards:** use only the **star-marked** cards (see list in Section 7), read aloud, with the picture on the front if you have one. No reading by students.
- **Answers by body:** FISHY = Hackles Up (brush up the neck, spikes!), REAL = star hands (jazz hands), PAUSE AND ASK = Pause Palm. No answer cards needed.
- **Scoring:** no counting. Put **one pom-pom in the Pearl Jar per card, always**. "Every card makes the jar fuller! The jar is full when we have learned 10 things."
- **Crew bit:** Peeper the sky-blue critter (a puppet or a picture on a stick) "looks" at each card and says "Hmmmm..." before the Whisper Think.
- **Time:** 6 to 8 cards, 10 minutes. A second round next day.
- **Lesson:** L3 Pause and Ask, L8 Real or Pretend?

3-5 "POND PATROL" (AGES 8-10)

- Full rules as written. Use the **SPOT** checklist as the bonus clue list: **Secrets**, **Pressure**, **Offers too good to be true**, **Tricks to move you** (like a link or asking for a password).
- Add a **SPOT Spinner**: after each card, one team picks which SPOT letter the clue belongs to.
- Add the **Help Ladder bonus**: after any FISHY card, the first team to say the right Ladder rung ("Rung 3: a trusted adult") earns a Pond circle (max 1 per card). (*Rung numbers follow the Help Ladder in 02: 1 You (Pause), 2 A friend, 3 A trusted adult, 4 A reporting channel.*)
- **Lesson:** L3 Scam Spotters, L8 Real or Fake?, L10 Oops Recovery.

6-8 "PHISH LAB LIVE" (AGES 11-13)

- Use the 6-12 deck. Use the **FLAGS** checklist: **F**ast (rush or threat), **L**ogin ask (password, code, account info), **A** amazing offer, **G**otta keep it secret, **S**trange sender or link.
- **Defend It (volunteers only):** any team that showed a different answer from most of the class *may* take 20 seconds to explain its thinking politely, or may say "Pass". Never call a team out. The class

may change its card after listening (no penalty). Teaches that smart people disagree and then check.

- **Second channel:** every REAL answer must name how you'd confirm it: "I'd open the app myself" or "I'd ask in person".
- **Lesson:** L3 Phish Lab; with (H) cards, L7.

9-12 "SECOND-CHANNEL CHALLENGE" (AGES 14-18)

- Use the 6-12 deck. Teams must **name a "second channel"** (a different way to confirm: call a number you already have, open the official app directly, ask in person, search for the original source) before showing PAUSE AND ASK or REAL. A card with a named channel earns **+1 Verify Pearl**.
- **Who benefits?** On every FISHY card, a team asks: "Who gains if I act in the next five minutes?" and says the answer.
- **Twin Flip** is always on. After the sort, the team writes the *one-sentence difference* between the real twin and the fishy twin.
- **Time:** run Full Pond in 30 minutes, or a 15-minute "Lightning Pond": 12 cards, 6 seconds each.
- **Lesson:** L3 Social Engineering Case Lab, L6 Synthetic Media and Truth, L2 Credentials and Passkeys.

OTHER VARIANTS (ANY BAND)

- **Real-ify:** For a FISHY card, ask: "How would a *real* message do this differently?" Teams rewrite the message as a safe one (for example, "Teacher says class prize on Friday in person"). Teaches what safe looks like.
- **Table game (2 to 4 players):** Each player in turn is the Reader. Everyone plays the three answer cards. Play 12 cards. Pond of 20 circles (same Pond rules: +1 per card, +1 if at least half the players showed the best answer, +1 per new clue). A good 10-minute indoor-recess game.
- **Solo "Spotter Practice":** A student reads cards silently from the answer side and sorts into three piles. Good for early finishers.
- **Hackles Hunt crossover:** Hide cards around the room. Students find, read and sort them (see Hackles Day).

HOW THIS GAME MAPS TO A LESSON (TEACHER NOTES)

1. **Before the lesson:** Play Quick Catch to surface what kids already know. Listen for misconceptions ("a real link has https so it is safe" [VERIFY: https only means the connection is encrypted, not that the site is trustworthy]).
2. **After the lesson:** Play Full Pond as review. Use the Oops cards to reinforce that recovery is possible.
3. **After a real incident at your school** (for example, a fake giveaway DM going around): play the matching cards the same day. Kids talk about it more freely when the cards are "someone else's."
4. **Never use real student messages** as cards. The cards are all invented.

TEACHER NOTES AND CAUTIONS

- Cards use invented links ending in **.example**. Tell students ".example is pretend. Real ones end in things like .com."
- The reading level of the K-5 deck is about grade 2 to 4 aloud; in K-2 read with a silly voice and skip abstract cards.
- Some REAL cards might look suspicious to a skeptical teen ("a code arrived by text"). That is exactly the lesson: **real can look like fishy, and the difference is whether you started it and whether it asks you to do something rushed**. Do not let "everything is fishy" become the lesson. The point is *noticing, checking, and being calm*, not suspicion of everything.
- **Pick-up and permission safety:** a message on a screen never changes who collects a child or where they go. The school and the family agree on pick-ups in person. If a child asks "what if my grown-up texts that they are outside?", the answer is: "Find your teacher. Grown-ups and the school office check together."
- **Local swaps:** a few cards mention things that are common in the United States (gift cards, Social Security numbers, 1-800 numbers, dollars). Swap in local equivalents (a national ID number, a local phone prefix, your currency) before printing.
- Keep a short "Parking Lot" paper on the wall for questions kids raise that you will answer after.

- Remember the disclosure box: if a child reveals they have been tricked, **it is never their fault**. Pause the game, thank them, and follow your guide.

7 The K-5 deck (66 cards)

How to read this table. "Card" is the front, read aloud. "Sort" is F (FISHY), R (REAL) or P (PAUSE AND ASK). "Why and what to do" is the back. A star after the number (K1★) marks cards good for K-2. SPOT = **S**ecret, **P**ressure, **O**ffer too good, **T**rick to move you. Teacher: always finish each card with "Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell."

FISHY CARDS (22)

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
K1★	A pop-up on a game says: "YOU WON A PONY! TAP NOW! Only 5 seconds left!"	F	Pressure and Offer too good. Pause. Do not tap. Tell a grown-up.
K2★	A message in game chat: "Free 1,000 gems! Click here and tell me your password so I can put them in your account."	F	Trick : asks for a password. Passwords are only for you and a trusted grown-up. Tell.
K3★	A video says: "Don't tell your grown-up. This prize is our secret!"	F	Secret . A real prize never needs a secret. Pause and tell.
K4★	A pop-up says: "Your tablet has a problem! Tap here to fix it right now!"	F	Pressure and Trick . Tablets do not talk to you like that. Pause, find a grown-up.
K5	A grown-up's email says: "Congratulations! You are our one-millionth visitor! Claim your prize!"	F	Offer too good. Nobody gives a prize to the millionth visitor. Show the email to a grown-up.
K6★	A player called CoolKid2012 says: "I'll give you rare skins if you give me your login."	F	Trick : trading for your login. Pause, do not answer, tell a grown-up.
K7	A pop-up says: "Your game is out of lives! Type your name and birthday to get 50 free lives."	F	Offer and Trick : it wants private info. Pause. Never type name or birthday into a pop-up.
K8	A text from a number nobody saved says: "Hi! It's me, your friend! Click this link to see a funny video!"	F	Trick : pretending to be a friend, plus a link. Pause. Ask the real friend a different way.
K9★	A player you never met asks: "What school do you go to? Where do you live?"	F	Trick : private info. Do not answer. Tell a grown-up now.
K10	A pop-up says: "Your grown-up said it's OK to get this free game! Tap YES!"	F	Trick : claims permission. Only ask your grown-up in person.
K11	A chat helper says: "I'm your friend. Tell me your secrets and I will never tell anyone."	F	Secret . A program is not a friend and cannot keep secrets safe. Tell your grown-up.
K12	A game message says: "Your parent told me to tell you to type your family's card number."	F	Trick . Grown-ups never ask kids for card numbers this way. Pause. Tell.
K13★	A pop-up shows a shiny gold gift box and says: "TAP THE BOX FOR YOUR PRIZE!"	F	Offer too good. That is the Too-Good Box! Do not tap. Wave hello and tell a grown-up.
K14★	A stranger invites you: "Join my private game room! Don't tell anyone!"	F	Secret . A private room plus a secret is a "hackles up". Tell.
K15	A prize wheel says: "Everybody wins! Type your home address to get your prize."	F	Offer and Trick : wants your address. Pause. Tell.
K16	A message says: "I'm new at your school! Give me your password so I can see your profile."	F	Trick . New kids can ask a teacher. Never share a password. Tell.
K17	A pop-up says: "Free in-game money! Hurry! Type your grown-up's card number!"	F	Pressure and Trick . Never type a card number. Tell a grown-up.
K18	A message says: "Your friend is in trouble! Click here NOW to help!"	F	Pressure . Real friends in trouble tell a grown-up in person. Pause, then Tell.
K19★	A picture shows a dog that looks real, standing up and talking like a person. The caption says: "A REAL talking dog!"	F	Pretend picture . Pictures can be made up. Pause and ask a grown-up "Is this real?"

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
K20	A quiz says: "Which animal are you? Type your name, school and birthday to see!"	F	Trick: wants private info for a silly quiz. Pause. Tell.
K21★	A game player says: "Let's race to the prize! Don't tell grown-ups, they ruin it."	F	Secret. Pause and tell. Good games are fine to share.
K22★	A pop-up flashes: "ONLY 10 SECONDS LEFT TO BE A WINNER!"	F	Pressure. Real prizes do not count down. Pause.

REAL CARDS (22)

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
K23★	Your teacher says on the class page: "Story time is at 2. Bring your blue book bag."	R	Known sender, normal ask, no secrets. Real! Hackles down.
K24★	Grandma sends a photo of her cat in a hat, through the family chat that your grown-up set up.	R	Known sender, fun, set up by a grown-up. Real!
K25	The library's note to your grown-up says: "Your book is ready."	R	Known place, expected. Real.
K26★	Your mom says: "You can play your game for 20 minutes after dinner."	R	A trusted grown-up in person. Real.
K27★	After your grown-up installed it, a game says: "Update ready: new hats!"	R	Set up by a grown-up, asks for nothing. Real.
K28★	A video call from your aunt, with your grown-up sitting next to you.	R	Known person, a grown-up nearby. Real.
K29	The school page says: "Picture Day is Friday."	R	Known school page. Real.
K30	The family weather app says: "Rain this afternoon."	R	No ask, no secret. Real.
K31★	Your grown-up's saved contact sends a pizza sticker to the family chat that your grown-up set up.	R	Saved contact, family chat set up by a grown-up, no ask. Real.
K32	A teammate you know at school says in the class game: "Good game! Play again at recess?"	R	You know them in person. Real.
K33★	The family tablet says: "Time's up! Screen break time."	R	A timer your grown-up set. Real. Ember says: stretch!
K34	The reading app your teacher picked says: "Press play to hear the story."	R	Teacher-chosen, no private info. Real.
K35★	A drawing app asks: "Do you want to save your picture?"	R	A normal question. Real. (You can ask a grown-up where it is saved.)
K36	Your coach emails your grown-ups: "Practice moved to 4 pm."	R	Known coach, email to grown-ups. Real.
K37	A birthday video from your cousin, sent to your grown-up's phone.	R	Known family. Real.
K38★	A math game your teacher gave says: "Nice work! You finished level 2."	R	Teacher-chosen. Real.
K39	A text to your grown-up from the doctor's office you visit says: "Reminder: checkup tomorrow at 9."	R	Known place, no pressure. Real.
K40★	Your big sister reads you a message from Grandpa: "Happy birthday! Dinner at my house!"	R	Known family, in person. Real.
K41	A kids' video on your family's approved list says: "Next video starts in 5 seconds."	R	A real feature. You can ask your grown-up to turn it off, so Pause is yours to use.
K42★	Your teacher's class app says: "Your teacher invited you to log in."	R	Real, teacher-given, with your grown-up or teacher helping.

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
K43	A text from your best friend's parent, saved in your parent's phone: "Can Omar come play Saturday?"	R	Known grown-up, normal ask. Real.
K44★	The class pet cam says: "Hamster Hank is awake!"	R	Silly and real. Real!

PAUSE AND ASK CARDS (22)

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
K45★	A friend request in a game from a player named Starlight7.	P	You don't know who it is. Pause. Ask a grown-up before saying yes.
K46	A message says: "Hi, it's Grandpa!" but from a number nobody saved.	P	It might be Grandpa; it might not. Pause. Check by calling Grandpa the way you always do.
K47★	A video ad says: "Try our new free game!"	P	Ads can be fun, but they are not from your grown-up. Pause. Ask.
K48	A friend at school sends a link with no words: "Click!"	P	Might be the friend; might not. Pause. Ask your friend in person.
K49★	A pop-up asks: "Allow this app to use your camera?"	P	A big ask. Pause. Ask a grown-up.
K50	A message says: "I'm from your school. What's your teacher's name?"	P	Your school knows your teacher. Pause. Ask a grown-up.
K51★	A picture shows a giant cat taller than a building. It looks real.	P	Pictures can be made up. Ask "Is this real?" Check with a grown-up.
K52	A website asks: "Enter your name and age to continue."	P	Pause. A grown-up decides if that is OK.
K53★	A new game says: "Pick a name to play!"	P	Pause. Ask a grown-up. A good name is silly and not your real name.
K54	A video voice says: "Subscribe for a surprise!"	P	A surprise might be fine, might be fishy. Pause. Ask.
K55	An older cousin says: "Use my account to play, here's my password!"	P	Pause. Ask your grown-up. Passwords are not for sharing around.
K56★	A chat message: "Wow, you're good! Want to be friends?" from a player in a game.	P	Online friends are not the same as real friends. Pause. Ask a grown-up.
K57	A chat helper says: "I can help with homework!"	P	Might be OK. Pause. Ask a grown-up first. A program is not a friend.
K58	A video shows a toy unboxing and says: "Link below!"	P	Pause. Ask a grown-up before any link.
K59★	A kid in a game chat asks: "How old are you?"	P	You cannot tell who is really there. Pause. A grown-up decides what to share. Tell a grown-up; if they keep asking, tell right away.
K60	A message has only a link and comes from a name nobody knows.	P	Pause. Do not tap. Ask a grown-up.
K61	A call on the grown-up's phone says: "This is the school."	P	Pause. The grown-up can call the school back on a known number.
K62★	A grown-up wants to post a photo of you and your friends.	P	Pause. Ask: "Do all my friends say OK?" Pip says: share what everyone is happy to share.
K63	A friend says: "Let's swap passwords to be best friends!"	P	Pause. Best friends do not need passwords. Tell a grown-up if the friend pushes.
K64★	The tablet says: "Install update now?"	P	Pause. Ask a grown-up.

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
K65	A game asks: "Use your location?"	P	Pause. A grown-up decides. Pip says: your location is a privacy shell.
K66	A kid at school says: "I know a free-game trick. Let's try it!"	P	Pause. Ask a grown-up first.

K-2 subset (stars): K1, K2, K3, K4, K6, K9, K13, K14, K19, K21, K22, K23, K24, K26, K27, K28, K31, K33, K35, K38, K40, K42, K44, K45, K47, K49, K51, K53, K56, K59, K62, K64. That is 32 cards, enough for four Quick Catch games. Skip K9 and K59 with children who are easily upset; use K45 and K56 instead.

8 The 6-12 deck (66 cards)

How to read this table. Sort: **F** FISHY, **R** REAL, **P** PAUSE AND ASK. **(H)** = Heavy card. Remove for opted-out classes. FLAGS = **F**ast, **L**ogin ask, **A**marzing offer, **G**otta keep it secret, **S**trange sender or link. All links are pretend and end in .example. Phone numbers use pretend ranges. In the back column: **Check** names a second channel.

Deck balance: 24 FISHY, 20 REAL, 22 PAUSE AND ASK. The 6-12 deck is deliberately a little fishy-heavy; the Quick Catch lists above are balanced 3-3-2.

FISHY CARDS (24)

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
T1	Text: "Delivery notice: Your package could not be delivered. Pay a \$1.99 redelivery fee at track-parcel.example/pay within 24 hours."	F	Fast , Login/payment ask , Strange link . If you are expecting a package, open the store's own app. Twin : T42.
T2	DM: "You won a \$100 gift card in our giveaway! Confirm your username and password at claim-gift.example to receive it."	F	Amazing offer , Login ask . A prize never needs your password. Do not click. Report and delete.
T3	Email: "Security alert: Someone logged in from another country. Verify within 1 hour or your account will be locked: secure-check.example/verify"	F	Fast , Login ask , Strange link . Open the app yourself; check settings. Twin : T43.
T4	DM from a friend's account: "omg is this you in this video??? pixelclip.example/watch"	F	Strange link + shock bait , and not like how your friend writes. Their account may be taken over. Check : ask them in person.
T5	Ad: "Earn \$400 a day from your phone! No experience! Send a \$50 starter fee."	F	Amazing offer . Real jobs do not charge you to start.
T6	Text: "Hi, this is Coach, I changed my number. Can you buy 4 gift cards for the team? I'll pay you back."	F	Fast and Strange sender . Gift cards are a classic fishy ask. Check : call Coach on the number you already have.
T7	Email: "Your streaming account will be suspended. Update your payment now."	F	Fast , Login/payment ask . Open the service yourself; do not use the link.
T8	Post: "Follow, share to 10 friends, and DM your phone number to win a console!"	F	Amazing offer ; asks for private info. Do not share.
T9	Text: "Hi, I sent my verification code to you by mistake. Can you read it back to me?"	F	Login ask . Never share a code. The code is a key to your account. Twin : T26.
T10	Page: "Free VIP skin generator! No download! Just log in with your game account."	F	Amazing offer , Login ask . Skins are not free to "generate".
T11	Marketplace: "Selling 2 tickets for tomorrow's big concert, half price, pay with gift cards only."	F	Amazing offer , Fast , odd payment. Use the official ticket site.
T12	School-looking email: "The principal needs a favor. Reply with your phone number."	F	Strange sender (address is a free mail service), asks for private info. Check : ask a teacher in person.
T13	Pop-up: "Your computer is infected! Call 1-800-555-0101 now!"	F	Fast scare . Pop-ups do not know your computer. Close the tab. Tell an adult.
T14	An online friend writes: "I've got something for you, but it has to stay between us. Switch to a private app?"	F	Gotta keep it secret . Do not switch. Tell a trusted adult.
T15 (H)	Message: "I'll post your private chats to everyone unless you send me \$30 in gift cards. You have 1 hour."	F	Fast threat . Do NOT pay. STOP (no reply, no pay). SAVE words and links. TELL a trusted adult. REPORT on the platform. It is never your fault.
T16	Browser banner: "Your device is out of date. Download this required update now." from an unknown site.	F	Fast , Strange link . Updates come from your settings, not banners. Twin : T29.

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
T17 (H)	A voice message sounds like your cousin: "I'm in trouble and need money right now. Don't tell my parents."	F	Fast, Gotta keep it secret, money. Voices can be copied [VERIFY current state of voice cloning]. Check: call your cousin on the saved number. Use your Family Code Word.
T18	DM: "Your photo was reported for copyright. Appeal here or your account will be deleted in 24 hours."	F	Fast, Login ask. Check your account yourself.
T19	Email: "A distant relative left you \$2 million. Send your bank details to receive it."	F	Amazing offer. Do not reply.
T20	DM from a stranger: "Love your art! I'll pay \$200 for a commission. I'll overpay by mistake, you refund the difference."	F	Amazing , odd payment. The overpayment is the trick. Do not send money back.
T21	DM: "Verify your age: upload a photo of your ID and a selfie to keep your account."	F	Login ask, Strange link. Real age checks happen inside the real app. Never send ID in a DM.
T22	Chat: "Free crypto doubler! Send 0.1 and get 0.2 back instantly."	F	Amazing offer. [VERIFY] Nothing doubles your money.
T23	A survey: "Complete this survey about your school for a \$50 voucher. Enter name, address, school, parent's email."	F	Amazing , private info. Ask a trusted adult.
T24	Email: "Your account was selected for a lottery! Confirm your date of birth and Social Security number."	F	Amazing , Login ask. Never share ID numbers.

REAL CARDS (20)

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
T25	School email from your teacher's school address: "Assignment due Friday. See the class page."	R	Known sender, normal ask. Real.
T26	You just tried to log in; your phone shows: "Your verification code is 482913. It expires in 10 minutes. Do not share it."	R	You started it. Real. Never share the code. Twin: T9.
T27	In the official app you opened: "Your friend Sam posted for the first time in 2 weeks."	R	In-app, no ask. Real.
T28	Email receipt for something you just bought, with an order number you recognize.	R	Expected. Real. Check it matches.
T29	In your phone's Settings, which you opened yourself, you see: "A software update is ready. Install tonight?"	R	You went to Settings yourself; no rush, no link. Real. Twin: T16.
T30	A sports league newsletter you signed up for shows the weekend schedule.	R	You signed up. Real.
T31	Your parent texts: "Can you pick up bread on the way home?"	R	Saved contact, normal. Real.
T32	In the app's settings (opened by you): "We updated our terms. View changes."	R	In-app and not rushed. Real. Read before agreeing.
T33	Pharmacy text you opted into: "Your prescription is ready."	R	Expected. Real.
T34	A friend says in person: "I made a new account. Follow me!" Then you see a new follower.	R	Confirmed in person. Real.
T35	Your new phone asks: "Sign in from a new device? Yes, this was me / No."	R	You just got a new phone. Real.
T36	The coach's team chat: "Practice is canceled due to rain."	R	Known chat. Real.
T37	Email from the college you applied to: "We have received your application."	R	You applied. Real.
T38	Official app: "Your plan renews on the 14th."	R	In-app, no ask. Real.
T39	Repair shop text: "Your phone repair is complete."	R	You dropped it off. Real.
T40	A teacher shares a link on the class page you opened yourself.	R	Known source. Real.
T41	A friend texts: "Call me when you're free, I want to ask something."	R	No link, no pressure, sounds like them. Real. Twin: T6.
T42	You ordered a book. The store's own app says: "Your order shipped" with tracking.	R	You started it. Real. Twin: T1.

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
T43	You open the real app and see: "New sign-in from a laptop. Was this you?" You review it inside the app.	R	You went to the app yourself. Real. Twin: T3.
T44	A relative says: "Remember our Family Code Word: banana."	R	You set it up with your family, in person. Real. A code word helps with T17. Teacher: "banana" is only an example and now everyone has heard it. Real families pick their own word and never say it in public or type it in a chat.

PAUSE AND ASK CARDS (22)

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
T45	DM: "Hey, we met at the game last week. Add me on this other app?"	P	Could be real, could be fishy. Moving to a different app is a flag (compare T14). Do not switch. Check: do you actually remember them? Ask a friend who knows them, and tell a trusted adult if they push or ask you to keep it private.
T46	A QR sticker on a hallway poster says: "Scan for free pizza on Friday."	P	A sticker can cover a real poster. Check: ask staff.
T47	Email "from School IT": "Your password expires today. Go to the school portal." (no link)	P	Plausible, but pressured. Check: type the portal address yourself; ask IT in person.
T48	A friend sends just a link, no words.	P	Check: ask them in person. Their account might have been taken over.
T49	A site asks: "Allow notifications?"	P	Usually choose No. Pause and check what it is for.
T50	An online store has a price 70% lower than anyone else's.	P	Check: search the seller name and reviews from another source.
T51	An app asks for your contacts and microphone "to work properly."	P	Pause. Do you need it? Footprint check: only allow what is needed.
T52	A "brand ambassador" DM: "We'd love to send you free gear. Fill in this form with your address."	P	Maybe real, maybe a data grab. Check: go to the brand's official site yourself.
T53	A widely shared photo shows a famous landmark flooded.	P	Check: lateral read (open new tabs: do trusted news outlets show it?).
T54	A voice note "from the principal" says: "School closed tomorrow."	P	Check: the school's official channel. Voices can be faked [VERIFY].
T55	A friend's video: "Try this new AI app!" It needs you to upload your photo.	P	Pause. Read what happens to the photo. Privacy first.
T56	A quiz: "Which celebrity are you?" asks you to "Log in with your account."	P	Pause. Logging in with an account gives the quiz access. Check what it can see.
T57	Group chat: "Anyone want to try this trading bot? Made me \$500!"	P	Check: who said it, does anyone verify? Likely fishy, but check.
T58	A pop-up on a free-video site says: "Your player is out of date."	P	Do not click. Close the tab. Pause.
T59	A new account with 3 posts and 9,000 followers likes all your pictures.	P	Pause. Could be a bot; do not DM; check the profile.
T60	Email: "You've been selected for a summer program!" You did not apply.	P	Check: the program's official website. Ask a trusted adult.
T61	A stranger gifts you in-game items "just because."	P	Pause. Gifts can be a way in. Ask: what do they want? Tell a trusted adult.
T62 (H)	Someone in the group chat posts a screenshot of a teacher saying something wild.	P	Pause. Is it real? Do not forward. Check the source. If it is meant to hurt someone: STOP, SAVE the words and links, TELL, REPORT.

#	CARD (FRONT)	SORT	WHY AND WHAT TO DO (BACK)
T63	A classmate asks: "Can I borrow your login for just a minute?"	P	Pause. The answer is no, kindly. "Let me do it for you."
T64	A message: "Group admin: Everyone verify your account at the link or you'll be removed."	P	Pause. Check: ask the admin in person.
T65	A "free" trial wants your payment info and says "cancel anytime."	P	Pause. Check: terms, who pays, ask a trusted adult.
T66 (H)	An anonymous post shows a classmate's photo with a mean caption.	P	Pause. Do not share it. Upstander: Say it, Stand with, Keep it (do not pass it), or Tell it. SAVE the post link, TELL, REPORT.

TWIN PAIRS (FOR TWIN FLIP)

11 pairs, 11 different fishy cards and 11 different real cards. (An earlier draft used T32 twice; T16 now pairs with T29.)

FISHY	REAL	WHAT'S DIFFERENT?
T1 (fake delivery text)	T42 (real shipped notice in the store's own app)	You started the order; the real one is in the store's app.
T3 (fake security alert email with a timer)	T43 (a real notice you reviewed by opening the app)	You went to the app yourself; no timer.
T9 (asks you to read back a code)	T26 (code you asked for)	You started it; real codes are never to be shared.
T6 (new number gift card ask)	T41 (friend asks to talk)	Real asks have no money, no pressure, no secrecy.
T7 (suspended account, update payment)	T38 (in-app renewal date)	Real notices inside the app need no action in a hurry.
T12 (principal favor email)	T25 (teacher email, class page)	Known address and a normal ask.
T18 (copyright appeal threat)	T32 (updated terms in settings)	Real ones are in the app and not threats.
T21 (upload ID in a DM)	T35 (sign-in on new device)	Real steps happen inside the app.
T24 (lottery)	T37 (application received)	You applied.
T4 (friend DM with link, off)	T34 (friend says in person: new account)	You confirmed in person.
T16 (update banner)	T29 (update notice in Settings you opened)	Real updates come from your own settings or the official store, not a banner.

Learning-goal tip for teachers: after any Twin Flip, ask: "What did you do to *check*?" Collect the second channels the class names. Post them: *Open the app myself. Call the number I already have. Ask in person. Look for the original source.*

9 Quick teacher script (read this the first time)

Field note

No. 2

Teacher: "Today we're going to be Peeper's Pond Patrol. Peeper is a big-eyed friend who looks very closely at things. I'll read a message or a situation. You'll whisper with your team, then show me FISHY, REAL, or PAUSE AND ASK. If you're not sure, PAUSE AND ASK is a super move. If you say FISHY and it was real, that is a great check! A false alarm is fine. Let's fill the pond together. Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell. First card..."

For 6-12: "We're going to sort real from fishy. You will see that real messages can look like fishy ones, and the difference is usually who started the conversation and whether you are being rushed. You will also see that 'I'm not sure' is a perfectly smart answer. Our goal is the pond: thirty pearls together."

10 Printable card backs (for the Reader)

For consistent reading, the Reader says after each card: "**Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell.**" and then points to the right signal: Hackles Up (brush up the neck), Pause Palm, Check Eyes or magnifier, Tell Wave.

11 Making it your own

- **Add local cards** (invented, not real): "The cafeteria app says lunch is pizza." (R) Replace names with your school mascot.
- **Add translations:** read the cards in your students' home languages. The three answer cards are universal.
- **Let students co-design the Pond Mat** (color and decorate it). Coloring is a nice early-finisher task.
- **Print a "Spot the Fishy" poster** with the three answer cards and the SPOT or FLAGS list. Tape it up.

12 Accessibility variants

NEED	WHAT TO DO
Color-vision difference	The three answer cards differ by shape, word and notched corner , not just color (fish, star, hand). Pass cards say PASS and carry a check mark. Pond Mat rows are labeled by name (Shore, Shallows, Deep), not by color.
Low vision / blind	Large print (at least 24 pt for the front of each card). Read every card aloud. Raised-dot or felt stickers on the three answer cards. Pond circles can be felt (buttons, pom-poms).
Deaf or hard of hearing	Show the front of every card on a screen or hold it up; the Reader points to the text as they read. Use a visual 10-second timer. "Peek!" is a raised hand, not a sound. Answers are visual cards.
Dyslexia / reading difficulty	The Reader reads aloud; cards use short sentences and a clear sans-serif font. Pair a picture or symbol with each card (see Printables). Allow answering by pointing.
English language learners	Read the card in English, then a helper reads it in the home language (the three answer cards are universal). Point to the picture or keyword. Let a team answer in any language. Swap idioms for plain words if needed.
Motor or fine-motor needs	Answers can be said ("Fishy", "Real", "Pause and ask"), pointed at on a poster, or tapped on a tray. Cards on a stand or velcro. Teams sit at wheelchair-height tables (about 90 cm / 36-inch aisles).
Sensory / noise sensitive	Whisper-think is silent huddling. Replace the cheer with waving hands. A quiet corner with a Pass card. Keep the announcer voice for pop-up cards gentle.
Anxiety about being wrong	Everyone shows cards at the same moment; nobody answers alone. The scoring table never goes below 1. Pass is always available.
K-2 or developmental differences	Use the star subset, body answers, and no counting. Fewer cards (6) and more movement.

13 Printables checklist (print and cut exactly this)

Art for all items comes from the art team. Reference these files in [kit/09_Art/characters/](#) (do not edit them).

#	PRINT	HOW MANY	CUT / ASSEMBLE	ART TO USE
1	K-5 deck (Section 7, 3 tables)	66 cards (print the 2-column table, front / back)	Cut 66 cards. For K-2 pull the 32 star cards (K1, K2, K3, K4, K6, K9, K13, K14, K19, K21, K22, K23, K24, K26, K27, K28, K31, K33, K35, K38, K40, K42, K44, K45, K47, K49, K51, K53, K56, K59, K62, K64).	peeper.png corner icon on every back; hackle_up.png on FISHY backs; hackle_happy.png on REAL backs
2	6-12 deck (Section 8)	66 cards (62 if you remove the four (H) cards T15, T17, T62, T66)	Cut 66 cards. Mark each card's twin number lightly in a corner.	Icon only: kit/09_Art/icon_spot_it.png (no mascot on 6-12 cards)
#	PRINT	HOW MANY	CUT / ASSEMBLE	ART TO USE
3	Answer cards	3 per team x up to 6 teams = 18 cards (6 FISHY fish-shaped, 6	Cut to shape, notch a different corner on each type	hackle_up.png (FISHY), hackle_happy.png (REAL), peeper.png (PAUSE AND ASK)

#	PRINT	HOW MANY	CUT / ASSEMBLE	ART TO USE
		REAL star-shaped, 6 PAUSE AND ASK hand-shaped)		
4	Pass cards	1 per child (30), green, word PASS plus check mark	Cut to business-card size	buddy.png
5	Pond Mat	1 sheet (30 circles in 3 rows) + 1 Lagoon strip (24 circles) + 1 Mini Pond (12 circles)	Tape the strip under the mat	peeper.png (Shore), hackle_proud.png (Shallows), fixit.png (Deep). The Too-Good Box with a party hat on circle 30: [ART REQUEST: Gifty art is not yet in characters/; ask the art team for gifted.png]
6	Three-answer poster + SPOT / FLAGS poster	1 each (poster size, or tape 4 pages together)	None	crew_group.png
7	Reader's Quick Start	1 (the Teacher Quick Start page)	Fold; keep with the deck	none
8	Pearls (optional)	54 pom-poms, beans or paper circles	None	none
9	Spotter Stickers / Passport stamps	1 per child	None	hackle_proud.png

Cut list total: 66 deck cards + 18 answer cards + 30 Pass cards = **114 cards**
per set with the K-5 deck, or 110 if you remove the (H) cards from the
6-12 deck.